

Using Xposed Framework to Tweak Your Android

The Xposed Framework is for modules that can change the behaviour of the system and the apps. With Xposed, you do not have to flash a ROM on your phone (a risky business) as you can modify its behaviour by using Xposed modules, which can change the behaviour of your apps. With Xposed, the ultimate level of customisation is possible on your phone.

Android is all about customisation. You can push the limits of your phone and, of course, your creativity, once you root your device. After rooting, there comes a new phase in you and your phone's life, as you install uber-cool apps like Greenify, Titanium Backup, change the boot animations, and much more. You can even change your whole user experience by flashing custom mods and ROMs, but you lose the stability and reliability of your pre-installed vanilla Android. Wouldn't it be awesome if you could have the exotic features of custom mods with the stability of stock ROMs? The answer is simple - Xposed Framework, authored

by two recognised XDA developers *rovo89* and *Tungstweny*. It allows users to change the behaviour of the system and apps without changing the APK via root access. The Xposed Framework has modules, each targeting a particular need. So, let's dive in. Note that this only works with root access on Android 4.0.3 or later

Warning

Before you dive in, wear a life jacket! Since it requires root access, be careful about what you are doing because, "With great power, comes great responsibility." Also, Xposed Framework is likely to work best on stock ROMs with little customisations, as some modules may conflict with the custom ROMs. Though it works perfectly on most devices, neither the author nor OSFY will be held responsible if you damage/brick your device. Proceed at your own risk and do take a back-up. Words like *Notification bar* and *Status bar* or *Tapping* and *Clicking* are used interchangeably.

I tested this on my Micromax Canvas 2 with the Jelly Bean 4.1.1 stock ROM, and it worked almost fine :)

Installation

Before installing, do a full back-up as it's better to have a backup than to be sorry. Installing Xposed Framework is simple. Just download the Xposed installer from the Xposed site, <http://repo.xposed.info/module/de.robv.android.xposed.installer>. After downloading the APK to your device, just side load it. After installing the framework, open the app and you will see something similar to Figure 1. We haven't yet installed the framework. To do so, go to *Framework* and then tap the 'Install/Update' button. You may experience some glitches. Don't worry. Wait for a few minutes and after that, the app will request for root access via your *SuperSU/SuperUser* app, like in Figure 2. To complete the process, perform a reboot so that you can install modules. You won't see anything great until you install the modules.

Installing a module

Modules, as discussed earlier, provide extra functionality

